

Lynette Schwanger

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ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCE & STRATEGIC PROJECT LEADERSHIP SUMMARY

Graduate student in Ecosystem Science and Sustainability with a focus on water resources and carbon management. Integrating a proven background in business, media, and program leadership to bridge science and strategy. Passionate about transforming complex environmental data into actionable solutions that advance climate resilience. My core competencies and skills include:

- Data Management and Analysis
- Environmental Policy Interpretation
- Organizational Agility
- Translating Complex Analyses for Broad Audiences
- Stakeholder Engagement and Collaboration
- Strategic Project Development and Management

WATER RESOURCES AND ENVIRONMENTAL DATA SCIENCE EXPERIENCE

Radical Open Science Syndicate, Fort Collins, CO

March 2026 – Present

Water Database Specialist

- Developed a climate vulnerability indicator for NPS water treatment systems to assess resilience to future climate scenarios across 1,900+ water sources
- Built an interactive R Shiny app for NPS staff to visualize and query the Water Supply Database
- Produced geospatial visualizations and data summaries to support NPS water management decisions
- Automated data querying and cleaning tasks using R scripting to improve efficiency and reproducibility

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

Assistant Instructor | Environmental Data Science Applications: Introduction

January 2026 – Present

- Selected as Assistant Instructor after completing the course based on academic performance
- Facilitate weekly office hours providing R troubleshooting and data analysis support to students

Colorado State University – Selected Water Resources Projects

Reproducible Remote Sensing Model – Restored Wetland Photosynthetic Recovery

Spring 2026

- Built and validated a predictive model of wetland gross primary production (GPP) using HLS remote sensing data, spectral indices, and AmeriFlux ground-truth observations
- Applied the model across restored wetland sites on Twitchell Island to assess recovery trajectories and compare seasonal carbon uptake patterns

R Shiny Application – Interactive Fen and Wetland Map

Fall 2025

- Built an interactive Shiny application that compares three Colorado wetland and fen datasets and enables polygon-level queries to support transparent, data-informed environmental planning

Colorado Water Planning and Governance – Anti-Speculation Doctrine Case Analysis

Fall 2025

- Analyzed a Colorado Supreme Court case on municipal water supply planning, demonstrating how realistic demand projections and the “can and will” test help protect shared water resources
- Summarized takeaways for mountain communities managing growth amid climate impacts on water resources

Policy Brief – Fen Protection via Regulation 87

Fall 2025

- Reviewed regulations and authored a policy brief to Colorado’s Water Quality Control Commission advocating for stronger fen protections to safeguard water quality, drought buffering, fire resiliency, and carbon storage
- Recommended actionable steps including avoidance standards, stewardship measures, and improved fen mapping and database upkeep

Colorado State University – Selected Coursework

Water Law for Non-Lawyers

Fall 2025

- Assessed the benefits and limitations of different models of water governance
- Researched how institutions and governance mediate the relationship between society and water resources
- Developed capacity for interpreting and evaluating water policy to provide informed stakeholder input

Integrated Ecosystem and Sustainability Analysis

Fall 2025

- Conducted fieldwork and lab work to collect data
- Analyzed, synthesized, interpreted, and reported on sustainability-related data
- Examined, evaluated, and implemented sampling strategies associated with water quality and carbon management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lightswitch Video, Leadville, CO (Remote/Hybrid)

CEO | Founder | Partner

January 2019 – May 2025

- Led stakeholder and client meetings, translating technical needs into clear deliverables and timelines
- Fostered strategic partnerships and negotiated contracts to support organizational growth
- Directly grew Equinix account by 250% within four years
- Increased company net worth from \$56,879 to over \$1.8 million
- Cultivated a values-driven company culture prioritizing inclusivity and collaboration

Video Production Manager

May 2013 – January 2019

- Built lasting client relationships with organizations such as Chicago Tribune and Gannett
- Hired and supervised contract teams to deliver high-quality video content for clients
- Improved workflows through continuous process assessment

Video Production Coordinator

November 2011 – May 2013

- Established the Video Operations department, creating efficient workflows to scale operations
- Collaborated across departments to improve digital infrastructure and user experience

EDUCATION

Professional Science Master's, Ecosystem Science and Sustainability

December 2026

Graduate Certificates in Water Resources and Carbon Management

GPA: 4.0

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

Bachelor of Arts, English Creative Writing

May 2009

Bachelor of Arts, Cinema

GPA: 3.78, *Magna Cum Laude*, Dean's List, Honors Program

Denison University, Granville, OH

VOLUNTEER WORK

Lake County Search and Rescue

May 2024 – Present

- Provide emergency response support, delivering safe and efficient outcomes for those in need
- Apply skills in navigation, risk assessment, and incident command to ensure operational effectiveness in challenging mountain environments

Secretary and Board of Directors Member

January 2026 – Present

- Elected to the Lake County Search and Rescue Board of Directors as Secretary
- Authored a successful \$85,000 grant application to the CO EMTS Funding Program to secure radio equipment
- Track team certifications, attendance, and new member requirements
- Set agendas for monthly meetings and record minutes

Wildlands Restoration Volunteers - Stream Restoration Volunteer

October 2025

- Built beaver dam analogs and post-assisted log structures to restore floodplain connectivity and wetland habitat